# YI ZHANG

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City University of Hong Kong

## EDUCATION

**Ph.D. in Linguistics, City University of Hong Kong** *Sep. 2025–2029 (expected)*

**B.A. in Chinese Language and Literature, Beijing Normal University** *Sep. 2021–Jun. 2025*

## PUBLICATIONS

### Peer-reviewed Journal Papers

2026 **Yi Zhang**, Wei Lai, Aini Li, and Xiaoying Xu. Individual differences in tone perception and production during the emergence of a contact-induced new dialect: the role of dialect experience, gender, and autistic traits. *Journal of Phonetics*, 119, 101548.

2024 **Yi Zhang**, Lishan Li, Wei Lai, and Xiaoying Xu. The Influence of Language Loss on Tone Perception: Diminishing Voice Quality Cues in Preserved Tone Contrast. *The Journal of the Acoustical Society of America*, 156(6), 3707–3722.

### Peer-reviewed Conference Proceedings

2026 **Yi Zhang** and Aini Li. Tense Modal Voice, Not Falsetto: An F0-Specific Physiological Byproduct of the Extreme High-Pitch Tone in Kaihui Xiang. *In Proc. of Interspeech 2026*, Sydney, Australia, pp. 1754–1758.

**Yi Zhang** and Aini Li. Gender Differences in the Phonetic Realization of the Checked Tone in Kaihui Xiang. *In Proc. of Interspeech 2026*, Sydney, Australia, pp. 7363–7367.

2025 Songyuchen Yang, **Yi Zhang**, and Xiaoying Xu. Dialect-Specific Modes Influence L2 Perception: Evidence from Chongqing Dialect–Standard Mandarin Learners of English. *In Proc. of the 2025 International Conference on Asian Language Processing (IALP 2025)*, IEEE, Sarawak, Malaysia, pp. 188–192.

2024 **Yi Zhang**, Lishan Li, and Xiaoying Xu. Individual Differences in Tone Perception and Production in Emerging Dialect: A Case Study of Elementary School Children in Changsha. *In Proc. of Chinese Spoken Language Processing (ISCSLP) 2024*, IEEE, Beijing, China, pp. 269–273.

## PRESENTATIONS

### Conference Presentations

2026 **Yi Zhang** and Aini Li. Tense Modal Voice, Not Falsetto: An F0-Specific Physiological Byproduct of the Extreme High-Pitch Tone in Kaihui Xiang. *Interspeech 2026*, Sydney, Australia.

**Yi Zhang** and Aini Li. Gender Differences in the Phonetic Realization of the Checked Tone in Kaihui Xiang. *Interspeech 2026*, Sydney, Australia.

**Yi Zhang**, Xinye Zhang, Hai Hu, and Aini Li. Acquisition of Variation in Dual Immersion Preschools: The Use of Syllable-Initial Alveolar and Retroflex Sibilants by Chinese Heritage Language Children. *Hanyang International Symposium on Phonetics and Cognitive Sciences of Language 2026 (HISPhonCog 2026)*, May 22–23, Hanyang University, Seoul, Korea.

2025 Songyuchen Yang, **Yi Zhang**, and Xiaoying Xu. Dialect-Specific Modes Influence L2 Perception: Evidence from Chongqing Dialect–Standard Mandarin Learners of English. *The 2025 International Conference on Asian Language Processing (IALP 2025)*, August 3–6, Sarawak, Malaysia.

2024 **Yi Zhang**, Lishan Li, and Xiaoying Xu. Individual Differences in Tone Perception and Production in Emerging Dialect: A Case Study of Elementary School Children in Changsha. *The 14th International Symposium on Chinese Spoken Language Processing (ISCSLP 2024)*, November, Beijing, China.

**Yi Zhang**, Lishan Li, and Xiaoying Xu. Individual Differences in Tone Perception and Production in the Process of Dialect Emerging: A Case Study of Elementary School Children in Changsha. *The 15th International Conference in Evolutionary Linguistics (CIEL-15)*, July, Changsha, China.

Lishan Li, **Yi Zhang**, Jiajia Hu, and Xiaoying Xu. Perceptual Cues and Tone Distances Across Stages of Tone Mergers: Evidence from Similar Tones in Cantonese. *The 15th International Conference in Evolutionary Linguistics (CIEL-15)*, July, Changsha, China.

2023 Xiaoying Xu, **Yi Zhang**, and Lishan Li. The Influence of Language Loss on Tone Perception: Weakened Sound Quality Cues in the Preserved Tone Pairs. *National Conference on Man–Machine Speech Communication*, December, Suzhou, China.

## AWARDS AND HONORS

Outstanding Academic Performance Award, *CityUHK* *2026*

Outstanding Undergraduate Thesis, *BNU* *2025*

2nd Prize, *Jingshi* Cup Academic Works Contest, *BNU* *2024*

2nd Class *Jingshi* Fellowship, *BNU* *2021–2023*

1st Class Incentive Grants, *BNU* *2022–2023*

2nd Class Incentive Grants, *BNU* *2021–2022; 2023–2024*

## LANGUAGE AND SKILLS

**Languages** Mandarin Chinese (native); English (fluent); Japanese (introductory level)

**Programming** Python, R, LaTeX, Praat, VoiceSauce